



Embedded tweets improve

Twitter improved its embedded tweets feature to load faster and display content better, adding an "embed button"

A cleaner HTC "Sense 5"

A user on XDA developers claims to have the upcoming HTC "Sense 5" skin for Android which looks very clean and condensed



Careers in Web analytics and SEO

We take stock of the opportunities and focus on the skill sets required to hone your talent and excel in this line of work

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Due to the rapid proliferation of the Web and constantly-connected devices, digital marketing has become an inevitable career option for number-crunching geeks. And two of the most engaging facets of digital marketing are SEO and Web Analytics. SEO stands for Search Engine Optimization, and as the name suggests it involves knowing the nitty-gritty of search engines to attract users to your online properties – making sure that you gain a relevant audience and the search engine users gets exactly what they came for. Analytics on the other hand is about collecting and analyzing data collected from your websites and distilling the data into research which will help improve your website's performance.

Background

Before we proceed a quick primer. In simplest terms SEO is all about boosting your search engine ranks. You don't pay for clicks but you employ other changes like website improvements, copywriting, engaging your audience on social chan-

nels, building links and content to make sure that your site gets to the top of the search engines. As for how the search engines work, SEOs treat them like black-boxes you just cannot make out what is going on inside rather you employ a combination of reverse-engineering, experiments and educated guesswork to arrive on ways to improve your search-listings.

Web analytics on the other hand is measuring the footprints of a user's activity on your website and outside it, and regurgitating detailed reports and insights into user behaviour, so that you can calibrate all your marketing channels including SEO to better serve your customers. According to Avinash Kaushik, Google's Digital Marketing Evangelist, Web Analytics practitioners fall into two categories: Implementers and Data Reporters. Implementers are the ones who integrate code from vendors into websites while the data reporters liaison with the management to piece together insights into how spending in different marketing channels is affecting your website/brand.

Indian opportunities

India is uniquely poised in the digital marketing scene as it has something

very unique to offer to the marketers - it's fledgling online population. There are roughly some 120 million people online in India from its population of nearly 1.2 billion which is only about 10% of the population. About 13 billion advertisements are served month on month.

This industry is particularly on the lookout for experienced professionals in Analytics. This is just one part of the story though, "There are a lot of firms out there who specialize in SEO consulting, i.e. handle SEO for firms which outsource this work, but there is a dearth of organizations which provide the same services in Web Analytics", says Rakesh Makhija, Senior Business Analyst at Tatvic, one such Web Analytics consulting firm. On the whole there are opportunities galore, both on the in-house and consulting fronts, the industry is thirsty for talent and experience.

Profile and requirements

Passion and a keen insight in data are the very essential for a job in either of these paradigms. Aspirants looking for jobs in SEO also need a background in web development with hands on skills in both frontend and backend tech-